

Francisco Rau

Football Data Analyst — Recruitment & Player Valuation

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Summary

Player valuation is a pricing problem, and I trained for it twice: BSc Economics + MSc Data Science & Society (Tilburg). Alpha Scout is the proof — a player-valuation and recruitment platform I built solo, live at alphascout.pages.dev: 23,353 players, 155 leagues, calibrated 12-month probabilities, forward-tested against real transfers — built for the €0-15M market where real clubs buy. The numbers below include the ones that got worse when I audited them properly.

Football Research & Product

Alpha Scout — player valuation & recruitment platform

2024-2026 · live demo · Python, SQL

- **Values 23,353 players across 155 leagues** from ~98,000 player-seasons with observed 12-month outcomes; harvesting, entity resolution, models and product built solo, refreshed weekly.
- **Fair-value model (R^2 0.74 on 101,064 cases)** prices every player from performance, age, minutes, league strength and contract; the 12-month forecast reaches rank correlation (IC) 0.74 out of sample, backtested per league — weak leagues published too.
- **Calibrated P(rises) / P(falls) / P(rises 50%+)** per player: gradient boosting + isotonic calibration, rolling out-of-sample; calibration published on 62,035 held-out cases (AUC 0.87-0.92, Brier skill +0.30 to +0.49).
- **Forward-tested on real windows:** flagged-undervalued players were signed 1.7x more often than peers (19.7% vs 10.7%), ranked before the window opened — an audit I ran myself cut an earlier 3x claim to this.
- **Outputs a recruitment desk can act on:** squad gaps and budgets by position, shortlists priced to what a club actually pays, one-page player reports with the uncertainty stated.

Transfer-market research programme

2025-2026 · thesis-grade validation

- **A proprietary market signal**, validated on 6,300 player-window observations across the big-5 leagues ($t > 16$): statistically strong, economically material, and still underpriced by the market. The mechanism stays in-house — the edge is the product.

Experience

Data & Process Analyst — Netvice

May 2025 - Jul 2026 · Tilburg, Netherlands

- **Built the company's operational BI from zero** (a first in its ten-year history): SQL pipelines and reporting an operations floor steered by daily.
- **Forecasting model planning headcount 500+ days ahead** from planned volume, with capacity-choke detection — presented to and used by non-technical stakeholders.
- **Same math as football:** a percentile pacing metric comparing individuals across campaigns with different workloads — normalise-then-rank, exactly like comparing players across leagues.

Student Researcher — Philips

Sep - Dec 2022 · Eindhoven

- Linear models estimating subscription adoption across segments.

Skills

Modelling: gradient boosting, regression, probability calibration (isotonic), rolling out-of-sample validation, Brier/AUC/reliability curves, information coefficients, look-ahead auditing

Engineering: Python (pandas, scikit-learn), SQL (PostgreSQL), Streamlit, TypeScript/React, Git, data harvesting & entity resolution, AI/agent dev tooling

Football domain: player valuation, transfer-market dynamics, league-strength adjustment, age curves, positional role profiles, per-match event & market data

Languages: Spanish (native), English (C2), Dutch (A2, actively learning)

Education

MSc Data Science & Society (Business Track) — Tilburg University

2023 - 2024

BSc Economics — Tilburg University

2020 - 2023